

DEVA ANAND

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Early Talent Team
Whatnot

Dear Early Talent Team,

I am joining Whatnot's Early Talent Community to raise my hand for future Software Engineering opportunities. I am a Master of Science in Computer Science student at UMass Amherst, Class of 2027. I am working as a founding engineer at a healthtech startup and building a research lab's analysis platform through summer 2026, and I am looking for a Fall 2026 internship where I can do real production work on a product that people actually use. A company building live commerce at a scale that has no playbook to copy is exactly the kind of place I want to grow.

What pulls me toward Whatnot is that it is about turning a passion into a business, and I have done a version of that myself. I built Underdogs Fitness, a production MERN platform with Stripe payments that has been live for over three years, so I know what it takes to run something with real customers and real money moving through it. Before grad school I spent two years at Wysa engineering a multi-tenant NHS eTriage backend for 8+ UK clinical clients, processing 10,000+ triage submissions a month and contributing to \$340K+ in revenue. That taught me to treat code review, integration tests, and monitoring as the job rather than as overhead, because when you serve real users at scale, small mistakes cost something.

I also gravitate toward ambiguous, no-playbook problems, and in both of my current roles I own the architecture and the technical decisions end to end, from a founding engineer's full-stack work to being the sole engineer on the lab's platform. I like moving fast and picking up whatever language or tool the problem needs; at the Qualcomm Edge AI Hackathon I shipped a cross-platform desktop app with a fully offline, on-device pipeline end to end under real time pressure. That instinct to stay close to the user and ship the thing that matters is what I would bring to a team building an entirely new industry.

Beyond the code, I care about the community side of what Whatnot is doing, bringing people together through the things they love. I have tutored 30+ underprivileged students in programming through a non-profit in Tamil Nadu, and that belief in widening access is part of why building for a marketplace of everyday sellers appeals to me. I would be glad to stay in the loop as opportunities open up, and I look forward to the chance to contribute. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,
Deva Anand